



Vue's wireless home video network is an effective way to keep a close watch on your home

Feature

"Secured access to the corporate network is also a must," he says, adding, "Privacy at home and a good telephone instrument with speakerphone facility would be ideal."

Performance management

Security becomes a major issue in telecommuting. Adopting measures such as secured access to business data, phone systems, applications and other resources through secured, wireless and fast Internet connections can go a long way in making remote functioning possible (see box "How to make it work").

For long-term benefit, it is important for an organisation to put in place a clear-cut security policy as well as performance measurement tools. It also needs a way to handle softer issues by clearly articulating the total number of work-hours for such employees, and vacation time.

Amit Malik, Vice-President-East, Cisco India and SAARC, says, "Telecommuting is feasible only if the organisation has structured performance management approach in place." According to him, organisations need to be very transparent

about how to assess a telecommuting employee's work and productivity.

"We also have clear processes and advanced communication technology in place that allows employees to work efficiently, no matter where they are. As the employees' bonus is mapped onto productivity, it also provides a clear reason to deliver on work assigned," he explains.

Hurdles and benefits

Despite the fact that the advantages of telecommuting, such as increase in number of productive hours, better professional and personal life balance, less exhaustion due to reduced or no commutes and, more importantly, reduction in carbon footprint outweigh the negatives, the proportion of organisations adopting telecommuting is still small.

Many employers have difficulty in breaking free from the 'keeping an eye' mindset, and evaluating the employees on the basis of their physical presence, rather than their performance.

However, providing flexible working options does enable organisations to retain the best talent, even when they

are facing personal problems. In the case of women staff, this option works particularly well during times of family pressures or maternity leave.

Says Rajesh A R, Vice-President (temporary staffing) at TeamLease Services, "The concept can bring in potentially large gains in productivity and substantial savings in time and cost. At the same time, it offers good work-life balance to the telecommuting workforce. However, for these benefits to come to fruition, it is extremely important for companies to have excellent performance management systems in place."

Besides, telecommuting can also help enterprises in terms of talent retention and offering the staff flexibility on a regular basis, or when they are on long vacation or leave.

However, to be the change agent driving the concept, IT managers need to carefully explore the options provided by various vendors. They also need to examine the various technology options and weigh the pros and cons before offering a solution that can help the organisation extend this facility to employees. **E**

Content courtesy: ITNEXT

3M India
MCX
SEBI
HSBC
NSE
Barclays
Stumpp Scheule
GE Money
Religare Realty
ITC Maurya
Hyatt Regency
Taj Lands End
ICICI Knowledge Park
Hindustan Aeronautics
CP Office Mumbai
Nestle India
Barco
Jubilant Organosys
Hero Honda Motors
Accenture
Diamond Board

Partial List

Why Visitex™ is India's most preferred Visitor Management Solution ?

Visitor management software has become a de-facto standard for keeping a track of visitors in all major organizations. Corporates & governments world over follow visitor management as it is one of the best practices for maintaining safety & security.

While maintaining a strict control over security, Visitex™ provides a powerful yet a visitor friendly Visitor Management System. Courier management, conference room booking, ADS integration and many such important features are part of Visitex™. Reliability, unparalleled customer service & enterprise wide presence is the reason why Visitex™ is most trusted Visitor Management Software ...

Call us today for a live demonstration ...



Mumbai - 9324312153
Bangalore - 9379747477
Delhi - 9310889399
Hyderabad - 9347277000
Pune - 9326727467
Email - visitex@gmail.com

Visitex™
Visitor Management

www.scrum-system.com